

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 10
♥ 8 4
♦ J 4 3 2
♣ K 6 5 4 2

♠ J 8 5 3

♥ 10 9 6 2

♦ Q 9 6

♣ 7 3



♠ K Q 9 6 4 2

♥ Q 7 5

♦ 8 7

♣ 10 8

♠ 7

♥ A K J 3

♦ A K 10 5

♣ A Q J 9

West

North

East

South

Pass

2 ♠

Dbl

Pass

3 ♥

Pass

4 ♥

All Pass

4 ♥ by North

Lead: ♠ K

The bidding has been as shown.

Pretty good hand you have. Certainly good enough to make a Takeout Double that forces partner to the 3-level. Partner responds 3 ♥.

Some questions don't have a correct answer. If partner has ♥ Q x x x along with the ♣ K and ♦ Q he would bid just as he did and slam would be cold. But if he has four small ♥s and nothing else he would bid just as he did and you probably cannot make ten tricks. On balance it is probably best to just bid the most likely reasonable contract, which is 4 ♥.

Board 2

East Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 6 5 3
 ♥ 10 9 6
 ♦ Q 9 7 3
 ♣ 8 4

♠ A 10 4 2

♥ 7 5 3

♦ 8 6

♣ K 10 6 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 7

♥ Q J 4 2

♦ K 5 4 2

♣ Q 3 2

♠ Q J 9

♥ A K 8

♦ A J 10

♣ A J 9 7

West	North	East	South
		1 ♦	Dbl
Pass	1 ♠	Pass	1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♦ 3			

The bidding has been as shown.

You have a perfect 2NT opening hand. Trouble is, the opponents have already opened. You get around that problem by first making a Takeout Double. Partner replies 1 ♠.

You could not say 1NT on your first bid because that would show 15-18 points. Doubling first, then bidding the lowest level of notrump shows 19-20 points. Of course in both cases you must have their suit adequately stopped. Partner does the math and bids 3NT.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ A 10 2

♥ Q 2

♦ 9 6 3

♣ K Q 8 6 4

♠ K Q 9

♥ A K 8

♦ A J 10

♣ A J 9 7



♠ J 7 4 3

♥ J 10 9 6 5

♦ 8 5

♣ 10 3

♠ 8 6 5

♥ 7 4 3

♦ K Q 7 4 2

♣ 5 2

The bidding has been as shown.

You double and partner responds 1 ♦.

The pattern continues. Overcall 1NT with 15-18. Double, then bid notrump with 19-20. Double then jump in notrump with 21-22. So you jump to 2NT. Partner puts it to 3NT.

West

1 ♣

Pass

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♣10

North

Dbl

2NT

East

Pass

Pass

South

1 ♦

3NT

Board 4

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 4
♥ K 10 9
♦ K J 10 7 3
♣ A 9 2

♠ A K 10 3

♥ A J 8 2

♦ A Q 6

♣ 8 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 7 2

♥ 7 6 5

♦ 9 4

♣ K Q J 10 5

♠ Q 9 6 5

♥ Q 4 3

♦ 8 5 2

♣ 7 6 4

West

1 ♦

Pass

All Pass

2 ♠ by South

Lead: ♠ 4

North

Dbl

2 ♠

East

Pass

South

1 ♠

The bidding has been as shown.

You have no choice. You absolutely may not pass.

So you say 1 ♠. Partner now bids 2 ♠.

Partner obviously has a good hand. Your response showed 0-8 points and he still found enough strength to invite you to bid game. However, with your 4-point square hand you must decline the invitation.

Board 5

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 10 7
 ♥ J 9 6
 ♦ J 5 2
 ♣ 10 8 7 4 3

♠ Q 9 6 5

♥ 8 7 3

♦ 8 4

♣ A J 9 6



♠ 8 4 2

♥ A K Q 10 4

♦ A 9 7 3

♣ 2

♠ A K J 3

♥ 5 2

♦ K Q 10 6

♣ K Q 5

*West**North**East**South*

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♠

Pass

4 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by North

Lead: ♥K

The bidding has been as shown.

With 7 points you must make a minimum response. Even though ♣s is your best suit you should prefer to show a 4-card Major. So you bid 1 ♠. Partner raises to 2 ♠ and it is your turn to bid.

Your first response showed 0-8 points. Knowing that, partner still invited you to go on if you were at the high end of the range. With 7 HCP and a doubleton you are right at the maximum for your bid, so you bid 4 ♠.